

Chapter 147-1

79 Guanghai Road was the most unique building in Haizhou City.

A three-story red villa stood in the bustling city center, just one street away from a lively snack street and a vegetable market.

Both this alley and this villa had a strong sense of history.

What Gu Yixue was filming this time was a period drama.

Pushing the timeline back, it was the Republic of China era¹—a time of war and turmoil, an era that produced talented scholars and beautiful women, and also an age of dazzling nightlife and extravagance.

Those who loved it truly loved it; those who hated it truly hated it.

There was quite a bit of information about it online, but it was all speculation.

The only things that had been released were the director's name and the drama's name, with just a simple one-line description: An idealistic love story.

As for what kind of idealism it was, nobody knew.

But with Gu Yixue's name attached, it was a hot favorite for awards.

Whether the box office would be good was uncertain, but it would definitely be nominated for film awards.

Before today, Liang Shi hadn't received the script at all. To be precise, none of the actors in this production had received it.

There wasn't even a character biography or story outline. It was only after arriving at 79 Guanghai Road that they learned Gu Yixue was planning to film a Republic-era drama.

Filming idealism in a period drama was indeed a very bold attempt.

It required a very unique approach and extremely dire circumstances—a genre that heavily depended on the script.

It seemed Gu Yixue was very confident in her script.

Liang Shi arrived at two-thirty, half an hour earlier than the time Gu Yixue had specified.

This villa had been used as a filming location by many production crews, and renting it was extremely difficult.

But Gu Yixue had managed to rent it.

As Liang Shi walked in, she observed the villa's design. It was indeed very beautiful, with every brick and tile carefully considered.

When she entered, Gu Yixue was the only one inside the villa, standing by the window smoking.

The window was an intricately carved decorative window that didn't block the wind well. Because they were afraid of damaging the villa's character, there was no heating inside—it was only slightly warmer than outside, and not by much.

It would probably be the same when filming.

Liang Shi had filmed at tourist attractions before. For places that needed to be protected, the crew had to be extremely careful about everything, afraid of damaging anything. If you really couldn't stand the cold, you could hold a hot water bottle against your chest.

But open flames were strictly prohibited.

Gu Yixue was dressed all in black, which didn't quite match the setting.

Her hair was tied in a high ponytail, making her look sharp and capable. She had a small, delicate oval face and wore gold-rimmed glasses. When she turned around at the sound of footsteps, Liang Shi thought she would also be quite suited for acting.

"You're here." Gu Yixue had one arm resting on the windowsill. She exhaled a ring of smoke that dispersed in front of her face, carrying an air of aloofness.

Liang Shi felt she looked even younger than what her profile suggested.

Perhaps it was because of that face.

But her eyes were as deep as the ocean, impossible to see through, carrying a maturity that didn't match her face.

It should have been a very contradictory quality, but it blended well on her.

"Mm." Liang Shi responded.

Gu Yixue had already sorted all the scripts and had even written names on the title page of each person's script.

For actors, this actually wasn't a good director—the first impression she gave was of being dictatorial.

Having everything done according to the director's wishes meant losing the actor's creative space. Some actors with too much ego would find it impossible to work with a director like Gu Yixue, and intense conflicts would arise.

But Liang Shi wasn't worried.

She was the type of actor who could find a good balance between the director's requirements and her own artistic expression. Moreover, for Gu Yixue, she had completed the script independently—she understood the characters she had written better than anyone else. She didn't need others to do reading comprehension.

The most important point was that she could take responsibility for the characters she wrote.

What she wanted and what the actors needed to present should be the same thing.

No one could understand the characters better than the screenwriter herself.

This was why Liang Shi unconditionally trusted Gu Yixue.

Even though there were only the two of them in the room, they didn't talk much—there wasn't even basic small talk.

Footnotes:

¹ Republic of China era (民國): The period from 1912 to 1949 in mainland China, following the fall of the Qing Dynasty. It was a turbulent time marked by warlord conflicts, Japanese invasion, and civil war, but also a period of cultural flourishing and modernization in cities like Shanghai. This era is a popular setting for Chinese period dramas due to its blend of traditional and modern elements, and its romantic yet tragic backdrop.